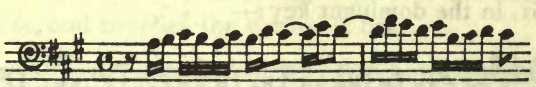the first subject is in the alto, and the second (not quite completed) in the bass; in bars 135 to 139 the first is the treble, the second is the alto. A short coda concludes the fugue.

The episodes, though numerous, are not of exceptional importance. They are developed, as usual, from suggestions from the subject (as at bars 37 and 129), the countersubject (as at bars 115, etc.) or the codetta (as at bar 49, etc.). See bars 23 to 32, 37 to 44, 49 to 54, 84 to 96, 107 to 111, 115 to 124, 129 to 134.

FUGUE 43 (Book II, 19)
A MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

A melodious little fugue, of such simple construction as to call for hardly any special remarks.

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the bass:—



The answer, in the alto, is **real**, and there is no regular countersubject. The codetta (bar 4) is in sequence, made from the last part of the subject. The treble enters in bar 5 with the subject; the bass in bar 7 with a redundant entry of the answer.

Middle Section.—The middle entries follow the exposition almost immediately, the subject entering in the treble at bar 9, in the key of F sharp minor. This is answered in the alto in bars 12, 13, in C sharp minor. The first episode (bars 13 to 16) and all succeeding ones are founded on the same part of the subject as is the codetta. The next entry is in the key of A (bar 16, bass) and might have indicated the arrival of the final section of the fugue; but Bach here treats it rather as the dominant of the

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 80-81.
BWV 888. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan
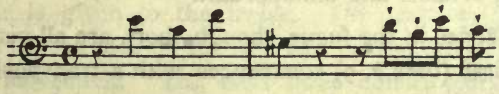
following entry (bar 20, treble) which is in the key of D, and therefore as still belonging to the modulating section. It will be noticed that it is made to close in D, not in A. The second episode (bars 17 to 20) separates these two entries, and contains incidental modulation into B minor. The third episode (bars 21 to 23) modulates from D into E, and in bar 23 the subject enters in the alto in that key, with its sixth note chromatically lowered.

Final Section.—This may either be regarded as starting from the entry just noticed (as the answer leading) or, perhaps more naturally, as containing only the single entry, in the original key (bars 28 to 29), with a cadential bar added. The episode which separates these last two entries (bars 25 to 27) gives the semiquaver figures partly by inverse movement.

FUGUE 44 (Book II, 20)
A MINOR (THREE VOICES).

One of the most interesting of the shorter fugues. We have shown elsewhere* that virtually the same subject has been treated in entirely different ways by various composers.

Exposition.—The subject, which is in the bass,



commences on the dominant; the alto (bars 3 to 5) therefore gives a **tonal** answer. The countersubject commences with the demi-semiquaver. A codetta separates the answer from the entry of the treble with the subject, with a new counterpoint in demi-semiquavers.

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* "Fugal Analysis," pp. 107-134.